

THE RIG VEDIC AGE (EARLY VEDIC)

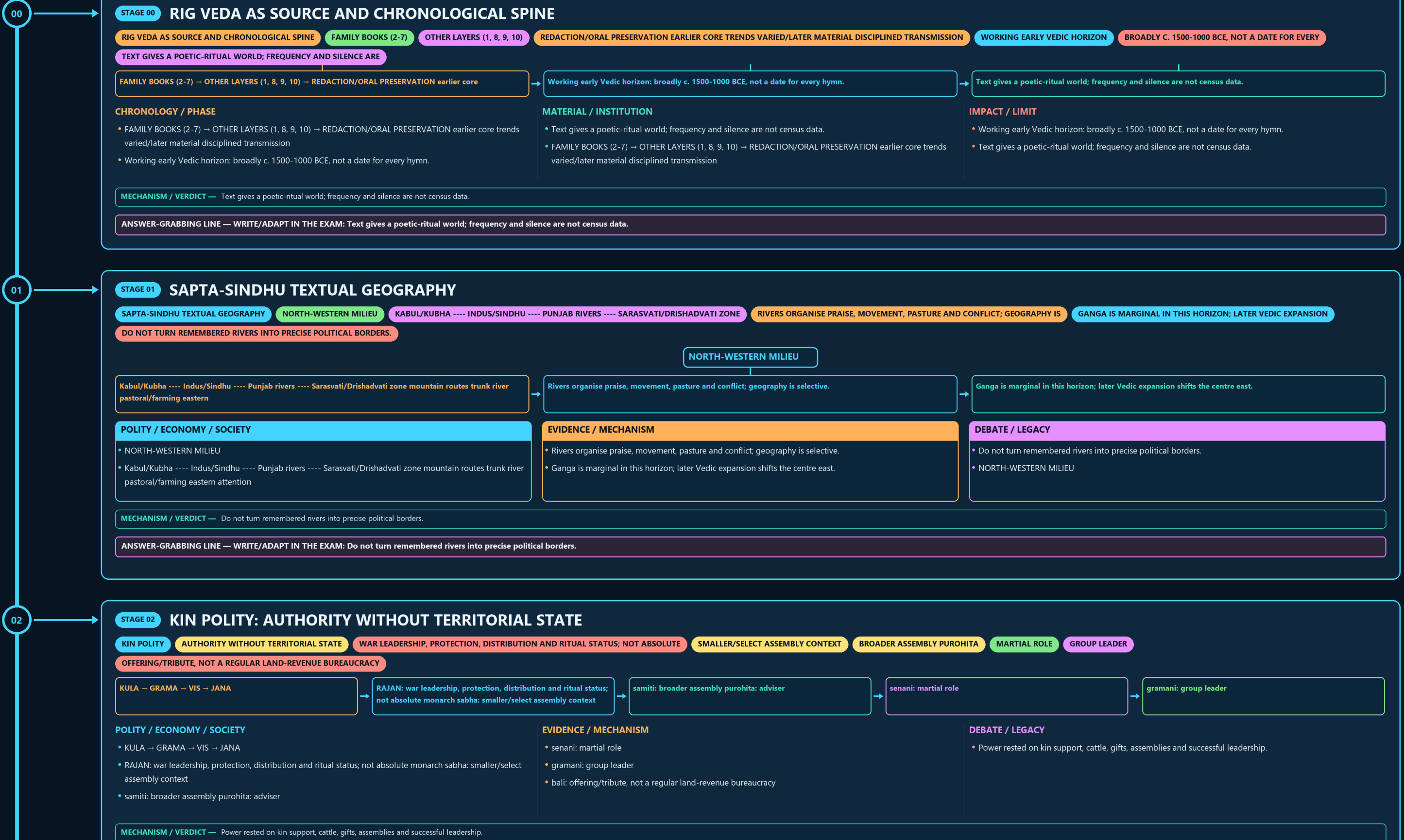
RIG VEDA AS SOURCE → SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY → KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT → CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP → SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND → DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



MECHANISM / VERDICT — Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.

02

STAGE 02

KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE

KIN POLITY

AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE

WAR LEADERSHIP, PROTECTION, DISTRIBUTION AND RITUAL STATUS; NOT ABSOLUTE

SMALLER/SELECT ASSEMBLY CONTEXT

BROADER ASSEMBLY PUROHITA

MARTIAL ROLE

GROUP LEADER

OFFERING/TRIBUTE, NOT A REGULAR LAND-REVENUE BUREAUCRACY

KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA

→

RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context

→

samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

→

senani: martial role

→

gramani: group leader

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA
- RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context
- samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- senani: martial role
- gramani: group leader
- bali: offering/tribute, not a regular land-revenue bureaucracy

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

03

STAGE 03

CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP

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PASTURE + WATER

CATTLE WEALTH

DAIRY, TRACTION, GIFTS, STATUS AND CONFLICT MIXED FARMING

BARLEY/YAVA + CULTIVATION + CRAFTS + EXCHANGE + HOUSEHOLD

PASTORAL PREDOMINANCE DOES NOT MEAN ABSENCE OF AGRICULTURE OR

PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming

→

+ crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping

→

Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava + cultivation
- + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.
- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava + cultivation

DEBATE / LEGACY

- + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping
- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

04

STAGE 04

SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS

KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS

HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE PATRON-CLIENT DASA/DASYU STATUS GROUPS TENDENCY

PURUSHA SUKTA IS LATE IN THE CORPUS; LATER JATI

HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE

HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners

Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

05

STAGE 05

DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

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05

STAGE 05

DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA

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ORDERED TRUTH AND COSMIC-SOCIAL REGULARITY

PRAISE + OFFERING + PRIESTLY SPEECH

PROTECTION, CATTLE AND VICTORY

RELIGION LINKS ECOLOGY, WARFARE, GIFT ECONOMY AND ORDER; TEMPLES

RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity

DEITIES: Indra-war/rain

YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech → protection, cattle and victory

Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

06

STAGE 06

CONFLICT, TECHNOLOGY AND CULTURAL INTERACTION

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HORSE/CHARIOT + BOWS/WEAPONS + MOBILE WAR BANDS CATTLE RAIDS

TEXTUAL CHARIOT TERMS MATTER; ARCHAEOLOGICAL CORRELATION REMAINS INDEPENDENT.

PRESTIGE CONTACT AND INCORPORATION

horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition

prestige contact and incorporation

Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and

prestige contact and incorporation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

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07

STAGE 07

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION

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EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC NORTH-WEST/SAPTA-SINDHU UPPER GANGA-YAMUNA AND EASTWARD

CUMULATIVE TRANSFORMATION WITH REGIONAL VARIATION, NOT ABRUPT RUPTURE.

RATNINS CATTLE-CENTRED MIXED ECONOMY PLOUGH AGRICULTURE, SURPLUS AND CRAFTS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and	yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning	EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and
ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and	VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.	ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and

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- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and
- prestige contact and incorporation

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning
- VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and
- ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

08

STAGE 08

RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

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10 MARKS

SOURCE CAUTION

HYMN TERM

15 MARKS

ARCHAEOLOGY CAUTION

20 MARKS

KIN SYSTEM

10 MARKS: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification

15 MARKS: geography → polity → economy → society → religion → archaeology caution

20 MARKS: corpus/layers → Sapta-Sindhu → kin system → cattle-agriculture loop

differentiation → ritual worldview → conflict/contact → transition

AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
10 MARKS: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification	20 MARKS: corpus/layers → Sapta-Sindhu → kin system → cattle-agriculture loop	AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.
15 MARKS: geography → polity → economy → society → religion → archaeology caution	differentiation → ritual worldview → conflict/contact → transition	CLOSE: a layered pastoral-agricultural kin society undergoing differentiation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ORIENTATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A1. TEXTUAL STRATIFICATION AND ORAL-FORMULAIC METHOD — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A2. GIFT ECONOMY AND REDISTRIBUTION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A3. INDO-IRANIAN RELIGIOUS COMPARISON — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A4. DASA/DASYU, VARNA AND BOUNDARY-MAKING — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A5. HOUSEHOLD, GENDER, FUNERAL AND PHILOSOPHICAL MATERIAL — [OPTIONAL]

A6. ARCHAEOLOGY, HORSE AND CHARIOT LIMITS — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

ADVANCED DEBATE

LEGACY / NUANCE

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.